Universidad del Desarrollo

Strategic Marketing

Certamen 2 · Nov 2026

InfoCar



B2B & B2C· For used-car dealers in Chile

What certainty is worth, and the market around it.

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What changed after the feedback

What we heard in class and in Certamen 1, what we changed, and where to find it.

	What we heard	What we changed	Slides
1	**Look at the Chinese-brand wave in used cars**	New figures: a third of new sales and 13% of used transfers are Chinese brands; depreciation and warranty differences	**5, 32**
2	**Explain SERNAC and how the legal market works**	Legal slide: what consumer law covers on a used car, SERNAC complaints, registry rules, data law and recalls	**31**
3	**Analysis too generic: look from the outside in**	A PESTEL radiography: country, industry and global findings, two sources beside each, plus what is still uncertain	**25–34**
4	**The private buyer is most of the market**	B2C population of ≈485,000 purchases a year in Santiago, with its own sample	**17**
5	**Hard data, consistent across slides**	Every figure checked against its source; four were relabelled (fraud cases, Chinese share, repair days, plan price)	**3, 5, 6**
6	**Don't show everything at once**	One message per slide; when presented, findings appear one at a time	**All**

Feedback from the Certamen 1 review and the class of 5 November 2026.

Dynamic: Information asymmetry

The seller knows the real car's condition.

SELLER

Knows the car

Past crashes, repaint, hidden filler, old faults.

?

Information gap

Condition is hard to check before paying

BUYER

Sees a price

An ad, a few photos, a short test drive.

RESULT

Every car is discounted

Doubt sets the price, so good cars leave the market.

What the gap costs

2.0–68.9M

CLP asking prices for the same model, the Ford F-150, in 2025. Price alone does not reveal condition.

Guzmán, 2026

52.3 days

average days from an insurance claim to the repaired car (2nd half 2025). Hidden damage is costly to fix.

Farías, 2026

Hidden condition = a cost on every deal

Concept: market for lemons (Akerlof, 1970). Sources: Guzmán (2026), Emol; Farías (2026), Autocosmos.

Big market, AI pricing arriving, but no Chilean dealer tool reads damage from photos

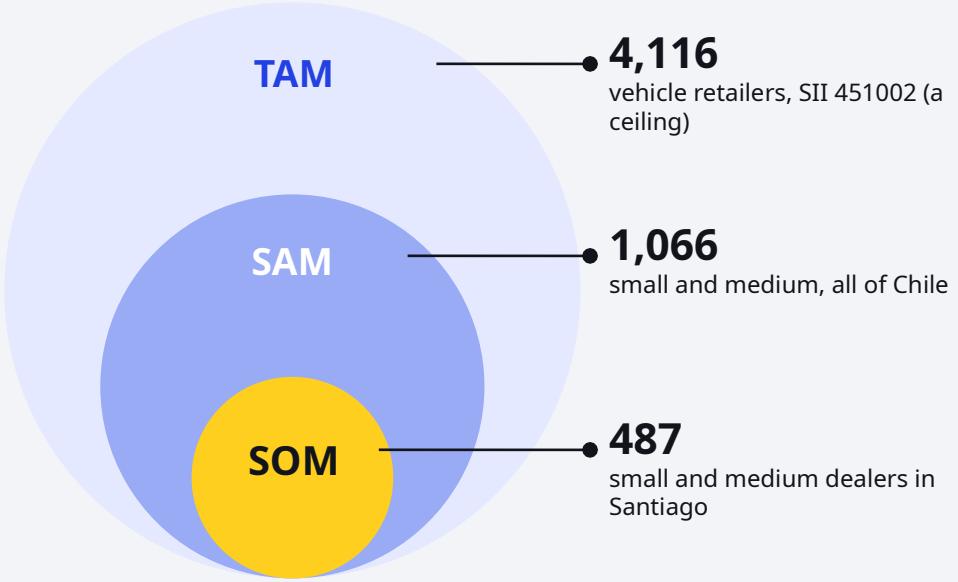
1,060,919
used-car transfers in 2025, up 5.8% · CAVEM (2026a)

15.3%
bought by companies, Sep 2026 · CAVEM (2026c)

58%
of transfers are in the Santiago Region · CAVEM (2026b)

3.4
used cars sold per new one · CAVEM (2026a)

Who we serve first SII, activity 451002



4,116
vehicle retailers, SII 451002 (a ceiling)

1,066
small and medium, all of Chile

487
small and medium dealers in Santiago

Competition

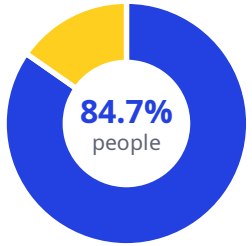
		Condition from photos
Rodar	Max purchase price from comparables and OBD2 readings. Closest to us.	×
GoAuto, AutoGest	Market pricing for dealers. No photo-based condition, no fault database.	×
Autofact, Carvuk, own eye	Legal history, in-person inspection or spreadsheets.	×
InfoCar Where we stand out: damage read from photos, plus a fault database by model and salvage auctions. No hardware; works on any car, even one seen in a listing.		✓

Sources: CAVEM (2026a, 2026b, 2026c); SII (2026): activity 451002, year 2025, and list of firms in Santiago, 2024 (includes new-car sellers; large groups and micro-businesses out of focus); competitor websites (Rodar, n.d.; GoAuto, n.d.; AutoGest, n.d.; Carvuk, n.d.), checked 26 Sep 2026.

Who carries the gap of information

Who faces it

Share of used-car buyers, Sep 2026 · CAVEM (2026c)



People 84.7%

Companies 15.3%

Most buyers are people, but few buy often.

How often they buy

Private buyer one car at a time

Average dealer **≈3 cars a month (half buy ≈1)**

Our scope: 487 dealers in Santiago

What widens it

Chinese brands, share of sales · CAVEM (2026c)

New cars · Jan–Sep 2026



34.2%

Used cars · Jan–Sep 2026

12.95%

They reach the used market with little local record of typical faults or part prices.

Who protects the buyer?

Legal cover by type of seller

✓ **From a dealer**
No legal warranty if told the car is used (art. 14); consumer law still applies.

× **From a private seller**
No SERNAC protection: the buyer carries the risk.

41,700 **fraud cases in court, all types, Jan–Sep 2025, up 64%**
Melelli Viveros, 2026

Dealers face the gap on every purchase, new brands widen it, and the law barely covers it.

Sources: CAVEM (2026a, 2026c); SII (2026), purchases per dealer = sales ÷ average asking price; Ley N.° 19.496 (1997), art. 14; SERNAC (2019); Melelli Viveros (2026).

What a dealer pays to know

Every way to check a car today is slow, expensive, or blind to its physical condition.

Pre-purchase inspection

82–102k

CLP per car

1–3 hours. A mechanic checks the car in person.

Serviteca CyT, Ojo Mecánico

Chileautos home inspection

59,990

CLP per car + travel

130+ points, digital report in about an hour.

Chileautos

Autofact report

6–9k

CLP per car (5,990–8,990)

Price and legal history. Nothing on physical condition.

Autofact

Portals + spreadsheets

Hours

of staff time per car

Each salesperson prices the same car differently.

Our estimate, to test in SO4

Working price hypothesis: about CLP 59,900 a month, below one mechanic inspection

Sources: Serviteca CyT (n.d.), Ojo Mecánico (n.d.), Chileautos (n.d.), Autofact (n.d.-a, n.d.-b); prices checked 26 Oct and 7 Nov 2026.

Your own mechanic in your pocket



01

Snap the car

Guided photos, plus make, model, year, mileage and asking price.

02

InfoCar does the maths

Market comparables + the model's typical faults (validated by mechanics) + damage detected in the photos.

03

Get a clear call

Maximum purchase price, repair-cost range, and Buy / Negotiate / Pass.

Max price = market value − repairs − risk margin

A pre-screen, not a certificate: photos can't see inside the engine or gearbox. The price comes from a regression, not from the language model.

So… how to close the gap

Two revenue lines: the dealer pays a plan, and a private buyer pays per report.

INFOCAR

Condition report

Damage and repair cost, built from phone photos.

One report, two ways to pay.

- **Visual appraisal with AI**
- **Parametric workshop budget**
- **Maximum purchase offer**

B2B · THE DEALER PAYS

Prices with the repair cost known

Monthly plan · CLP 59,900–149,900

B2C · THE BUYER PAYS

Buys a car from a private seller

Where the law protects least.

One report · CLP 7,990–24,990

Today vs. InfoCar	Mechanic inspection	Rodar	InfoCar
Cost per car	**CLP 82,000–102,000**	**Not public**	**≈CLP 20,000 (average dealer)**
Time per car	1–3 hours	Needs a scanner fitted	Minutes (goal: under 5)
What it checks	Engine, body, chassis	Engine data (OBD-II)	Exterior body only

Sources: Serviteca CyT; Ojo Mecánico; Rodar (n.d.). InfoCar per car = CLP 59,900 ÷ ≈3 cars a month (SII, 2026). Prices: hypotheses tested in SO5.

Why not just ask ChatGPT?

A general chatbot has no current Chilean listings, and when it reads car damage from photos it often invents things.

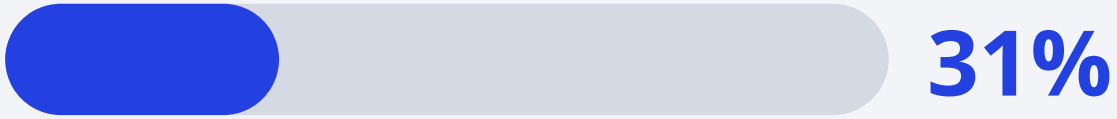
Vehicle damage reports with hallucinations

General vision model, image only



78%

Same model anchored to a dedicated damage-segmentation model



31%

100 human-checked reports (Hogale et al., 2026)

What InfoCar adds

- ✓ Up-to-date Chilean market data
- ✓ Vision models built for car damage
- ✓ Ranges with a confidence level
- ✓ Traceable estimates and human review

Accuracy is the top AI barrier for 74% of US franchise dealers (Cox Automotive, 2025): sell verifiable accuracy, not “AI”

Sources: Hogale et al. (2026), arXiv 2608.02470; Cox Automotive (2025).

What we need to understand to make it real

General objective: to understand how technical and economic certainty is valued when setting the transaction value of used cars.

Specific objective (SO) one dimension each	S Specific What exactly	M Measurable How we measure it	A Achievable Why it is doable	R Relevant Decision it informs	T Time-bound Weeks 1–4 (ideal)
1 **SO1 · Physical & aesthetic** **Identify** the physical and aesthetic attributes that determine how a car's condition is valued.	classification of body damages: dents, scratches, panel gaps, lights, repaint	Severity on a Likert 1–5 scale (1 = barely visible, 5 = structural)	Dealers judge these damages by eye every day	Sets the damage classes the app must detect	
2 **SO2 · Cost foresight** **Analyze** how anticipating reconditioning costs affects how the purchase offer is set.	CLP discount on the offer for each diagnosed damage	Choice experiment: blind case vs. case with repair cost	Pricing a trade-in is a daily task for appraisers	Calibrates the offer rule and the dealer's margin	
3 **SO3 · Adoption barriers** **Evaluate** the distrust barriers, resistance to automated diagnosis and technical uncertainty that shape transactions.	Fear of AI errors, of Chinese brands and of opaque appraisals	Coded objections + agreement on a Likert 1–5 scale	Objections come up on their own in interviews	Shapes how the report explains itself	
4 **SO4 · Workshop experience** **Describe** the operating experience and time bottlenecks of conventional exterior inspection and repair costing.	Days a car is stopped; hours to quote body and paint work	Time metrics (days, hours) + journey map	A known pain: 52.3 days from claim to repaired car	Sets the app flow and the time limit per report	
5 **SO5 · Appeal and adoption** **Evaluate** the perceived appeal, differentiation and adoption intent of a digital condition report vs. traditional appraisal.	B2B intent to subscribe; B2C intent to buy a report	Top-2 Box intent + Van Westendorp price meter	A clear stimulus: a mock-up of the digital report	Sets B2B and B2C prices before building the software	

T = theoretical plan, all five SOs within one month: W1 explore (stage 1) · W2 build and pilot the questionnaire · W3–W4 measure (stage 2).

Listen first, then measure

A mixed, sequential design: what we hear in stage 1 becomes the questions and scales of stage 2.

Stage 1

Qualitative, to explore

In-depth interviews (B2B) · Focus groups (B2C)

We learn the dealers' words, their rules of thumb for pricing, and what makes them distrust.

Explores SO1–SO5: the words and reasons

Bridge

Findings become variables, scales and closed answers.

Stage 2

Quantitative, to conclude

F2F + CATI (B2B) · CAWI + intercepts (B2C)

We measure the impact of each variable that we found, test our hypotheses, and estimate willingness to pay.

Measures SO1–SO5: how each variable impacts

Qualitative: one technique per customer

Interviews for what dealers keep private; groups for what buyers share.



In-depth interviews, one-on-one

B2B

Mid-size dealer owners | Appraisers

Why it fits best
Margins and workshop deals are trade secrets. Nobody shares them in front of competitors.

What it gives us
Hidden pricing rules, how far they trust AI, what fails in today's tools.

Technique · Semi-structured interview guide, 30–35 min, one-on-one

Moderated focus groups

B2C

Bought a used car in the last 12 months | Plan to buy one

Why it fits best
Fear of fraud is social: hearing others' stories makes people talk.

What it gives us
Shared risk perceptions, the buyer's own words, first reaction to the report.

Technique · Moderator's discussion guide, 75–90 min

Quantitative: meet each customer

Dealers in person at work, buyers online at scale. Phone calls and intercepts close the gaps.

B2B

F2F in situ + CATI

How we reach them
At the dealer's workplace, drawn from the SII list of firms: dealers rarely answer web surveys. CATI reaches firms we cannot visit.

Technique
Structured questionnaire on a tablet, 8–10 min, with the report prototype.

What it measures
Pricing rules at scale, reaction to the prototype, intent to subscribe.

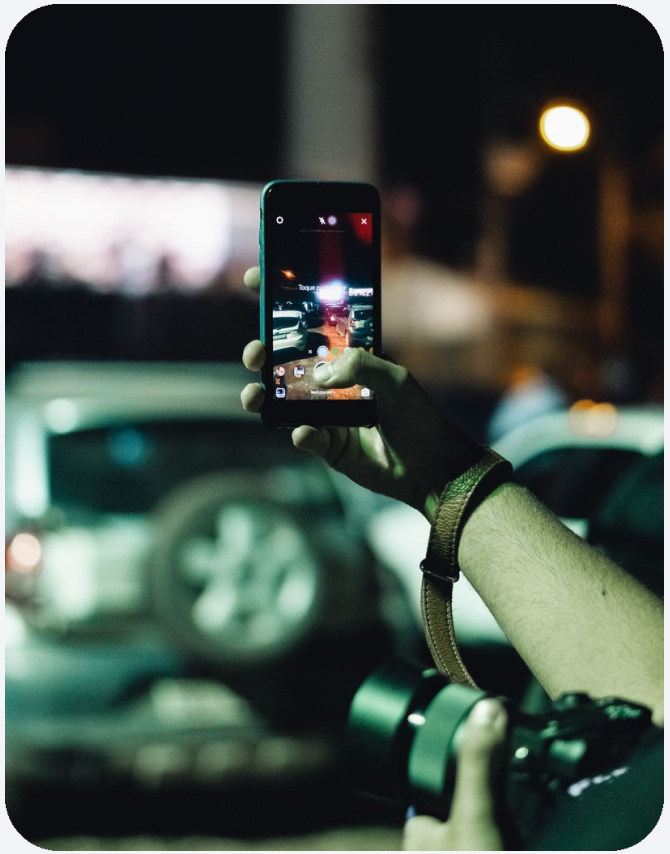
B2C

CAWI with quotas + intercepts

How we reach them
Online panel with quotas by seller type and purchase timing. Intercepts at notaries and PRT if a quota fills slowly.

Technique
Self-administered online questionnaire with the same report mock-up.

What it measures
How common each fear is, intent to buy a report, price range (PSM).



Each mode reaches one customer; together they cover both sides of the deal.

From method to objectives

Specific objective (SO)	Step 1 · Explore (qualitative)			Step 2 · Measure (quantitative)		Step 3 · Decide
	In-depth interviews B2B	Focus groups B2C	becomes questions	F2F in situ + CATI B2B	CAWI + intercepts B2C	Business decision
1 SO1 Physical & aesthetic	Words for each damage	Impact in the buying decision	→	Severity of kinds of damages, Likert 1–5	Most relevant aspects, Likert 1–5	Damage classes in the app
2 SO2 Cost foresight	Hidden costs	—		Choice experiment: blind vs. costed	—	Offer rule and margin
3 SO3 Adoption barriers	Objections to AI	Fear of fraud	→	Criticality, Likert 1–5	How common each fear is	How the report explains itself
4 SO4 Workshop experience	Where time is lost	—	→	Days stopped, hours to quote	—	App flow and timing
5 SO5 Appeal and adoption	First reaction to the prototype		→	Concept test, Top-2 Box	Intent + PSM	B2B and B2C prices

Who we will ask, and how many

Population and sample: the last link of the chain that starts with information asymmetry.

Diagnosis
Information asymmetry

→

Objective
What certainty is worth

→

Method
Listen first, then measure

→

Built in Workshop 3

Population
Who belongs, and who does not

→

Sample
How many cases, and which

Five rules we follow: from class, checked against the literature

Five dimensions

Demographic, geographic, psychographic, consumption and need.

Filters ≠ segments

A rule for everyone is a filter. Only segments get their own cases.

30+ per cell

The floor to read a cell. Prices and totals are read on bigger bases.

Diversity first

Stage 1 looks for different profiles, not for large numbers.

Ideal, then realistic

Only a census covers everyone. We show the ideal and what fits in two weeks.

B2B population: dealers who buy to resell

A named list from the tax office: the small and medium vehicle retailers of Santiago.

Who belongs

Small and medium firms that retail vehicles, compraventas included (SII 451002), in the Santiago Metropolitan Region, that bought a used car to resell in the last 3 months.

SII 451002 · 2,400–100,000 UF a year · RM only · Bought used to resell

Informant: whoever sets the purchase price. One per firm.

Also recorded: franchise or independent, share of used cars, mechanic on staff.

How many

SII company statistics and list of firms

- **4,116** vehicle retailers in Chile, 451002 (2025)
- **1,066** small and medium, all of Chile (2025)
- **487** small and medium in Santiago, with name and tax ID (2024)

Three cells by SII sales bracket

cars a month: SII average

B1 · Pequeña 1–2	B2 · Pequeña 3	B3 · Mediana
255 firms · ≈1 car a month	136 · ≈3 a month	96 · ≈9 a month

Out, with evidence

- × **Large firms** — Grande 4: 89% of sales
- × **Micro firms** — under 0.4 cars a month
- × **Importers** — 451001: wholesale
- × **Other regions** — 42% of transfers

Sources: SII (2026), company statistics 2025 and list of legal persons 2024 (RUT, bracket, comuna); CAVEM (2026b): the RM is 58% of transfers. Cars a month = SII sales ÷ CLP 18.4M average asking price (Guzmán, 2026), a reference.

B2C population: private buyers

People who bought a used car with their own money, or are about to. Five filters for all; two segments.

Filters

Everyone in the sample meets all five

- ✓ 18 or older
- ✓ Lives in the Santiago Metropolitan Region
- ✓ Bought a used car, SUV or pickup in the last 12 months, or will in the next 6
- ✓ Pays with own or household money
- ✓ Takes part in the decision

Segments

Each one gets its own cases

Seller type

Private seller or company. From a company, consumer law applies; from a private seller, it does not.

Purchase timing

Bought in the last 12 months, or will buy in the next 6: the real experience, and the need before paying.

≈485,000

used-car purchases a year by people in Santiago (our estimate)

Future buyers have no official count: the screener measures them.

Recorded, not quota'd

Income uses the AIM 2023 questions, anonymously

Age · Sex · NSE (AIM) · Car value · Knew the seller? · Inspected first?

Estimate: 1,060,919 transfers (2025) × 58.0% in the RM × 84.7% bought by people × 93% cars, SUVs and pickups. Sources: CAVEM (2026b, 2026c); SERNAC (2019); AIM (2024). Car value: next slides.

Who they are: five dimensions

Class rule: demographic and geographic always; the others when our objectives need them.

	B2B · dealers	B2C · private buyers
Demographic Always required	**Segment** Firm size: SII sales bracket **Describe** Informant's role, years in the trade	**Filter** 18 or older **Describe** Age, sex, NSE (AIM 2023, anonymous)
Geographic Always required	**Filter** Santiago Metropolitan Region **Describe** Comuna	**Filter** Lives in the RM **Describe** Comuna
Consumption SO2, SO5	**Filter** Bought a used car to resell, last 3 months **Describe** Channels, tools paid for	**Segment** Seller type × purchase timing **Describe** Car value by permit
Need SO1, SO4	**Filter** Priced a car without a full inspection	**Describe** Checked the car before paying?
Psychographic SO3	**Describe** Trust in AI, risk aversion, trust in own eye	**Describe** Fear of fraud, trust in technology

Filter = everyone must meet it. Segment = gets its own cases. Describe = asked and analysed, not a quota. Dimensions from class (Scherman, 2026a) and the brief (Scherman, 2026b).

We group cars by the value of their permit

Every car pays a circulation permit, set by law from the SII appraisal before any sale: objective and public.

How we set the cuts

- ✕ **Equal thirds**
  28% pay the legal minimum, so the first cut falls on it.
- ✕ **Legal tax brackets**
  Too unequal: 64% / 26% / 10%.
- ✓ **Dalenius–Hodges**
  The classic rule for strata of a skewed variable, on the log scale.
- ✓ **Fisher–Jenks check**
  A second method lands on nearly the same cuts.

Cuts at 100 and 200 UTM of appraisal so they hold every year. The three groups explain 86% of the variance in (log) permit value.

Three value segments

Share of used-car transfers, 2025

Low	**permit ≤ CLP 97,653** typical car: 2011	**55.7%**
Mid	**CLP 97,654–292,958** typical car: 2019	**28.0%**
High	**permit > CLP 292,958** typical car: 2023	**16.3%**

How we classify each car: brand, model and year → its permit in the SII table. Nobody has to remember what they paid.

Sources: SII (2026), appraisal and permit table 2026, 65,812 versions; weighted with CAVEM (2026b) transfers by brand and age; Decreto Ley 3.063, art. 12; Dalenius & Hodges (1959). UTM = CLP 69,752.

Stage 1: diversity, not numbers

Ideal design. Two interviews per dealer profile; one focus group per seller type and purchase timing.

In-depth interviews · B2B

5 profiles × 2 interviews = 10, plus 2 in reserve

			Interviews
1	**Small dealer** Pequeña · ≈1–3 cars a month	One with low-value stock, one with mid-value.	2 interviews
2	**Mid-size dealer** Mediana · ≈9 cars a month	One with an appraiser, one where the owner prices.	2 interviews
3	**Flipper** buys, fixes, resells	One buys crashed cars, one buys from people.	2 interviews
4	**High-value dealer** stock mostly in the high segment	One independent, one on consignment.	2 interviews
5	**Franchise appraiser** contrast, not target	One traditional brand, one Chinese brand.	2 interviews

Focus groups · B2C

2 × 2 = 4 groups

	Bought, last 12 months	Will buy, next 6 months
Private seller	**FG1** 6–8 people	**FG2** 6–8 people
Company	**FG3** 6–8 people	**FG4** 6–8 people

Inside each group

8 recruited · low, mid and high car value · mixed sex, age and NSE · nobody who knows another.

Stop rule: 2 interviews in a row with no new theme. Saturation: 9–17 interviews, 4–8 groups (Hennink & Kaiser, 2022). Class: 2 interviews per profile; per segment, 3 groups is ideal, 2 rigorous, 1 the minimum (Scherman, 2026a, 2026b).

Ideal: 100 dealer surveys in three cells

A random draw from the SII list of Santiago, cell by cell, with replacements.

n = 100

of 487 dealers, one informant each

±9.1%

reference error for the total, 95%, after weighting and the finite-population correction

≈180–290 firms to contact

firm surveys get 34–55% answers (Holtom et al., 2022)

B1 Pequeña 1–2

40 of 255

16% of the cell · ±14.3%
weight 1.31 for totals

B2 Pequeña 3

30 of 136

22% of the cell · ±15.9%
weight 0.93 for totals

B3 Mediana

30 of 96

31% of the cell · ±14.9%
weight 0.66 for totals

Why 40 / 30 / 30: a proportional split gives 52 / 28 / 20, so B2 and B3 fall under the 30-case floor. They go up to 30; the other 40 go to B1. Weights bring totals back to the real mix.

Choice experiment · SO2
3 car cards per dealer, one per value segment, priced blind or with the repair cost, rotated.

300 appraisals

100 per segment

50 / 50 blind vs. with cost

Error = 1.96·√(0.25/n)·√((N−n)/(N−1)); design effect 1.07. Firm-level response: 34% (2015) and 55% (2020) in 1,014 published surveys (Holtom et al., 2022). B3 means contacting ≈90 of its 96 firms.

Ideal: 300 buyer surveys in four cells

Seller type × purchase timing, 75 per cell. Car value is recorded and weighted to the market.

	Bought, last 12 months	Will buy, next 6 months
Private seller 150 cases	75	75
Company 150 cases	75	75

Why 75: well above the 30 floor, so seller types and timings read at ±8%.

How far each reading goes

Total	300	**±5.7%**
Per seller type	150	**±8.0% · prices read here**
Per timing	150	**±8.0%**
Per cell	75	**±11.3%**

≥220 online panel, quotas by seller type and timing

≤80 intercepts at notaries, a separate sub-sample

56/28/16 value weights

Reference error 1.96·√(0.25/n), 95%; quota samples have no true margin of error (AAPOR, Baker et al., 2013). Planners report the seller type they expect. Value weights: low, mid and high permit segments (previous slides).

Ideal vs. realistic: what fits in two weeks

Ideal = meets our precision targets with no time limit. Realistic = what seven of us can run in two weeks.

	Ideal (slides 20–22)	Realistic · two weeks	What we lose
Why	**30+ per cell and totals near ±10% or better**	**Seven people, two weeks, no paid panel**	Precision
Dealer interviews	10 + 2 reserve, 5 profiles	**8 + 2 reserve, 4 profiles, 30-min video calls**	The franchise contrast
Focus groups	4: seller type × timing	**2 online, 1 per seller type, 5–6 people**	The timing split in groups
Dealer survey	100 · 3 SII cells · ±9.1%	**60 · 2 strata of 30 · ±14.1%**	Small vs. mid-size only
Buyer survey	300 · 4 cells of 75 · ±5.7%	**180 · 4 cells of 45 · ±7.3%**	Cells: ±11% → ±15%
Choice experiment	300 appraisals, 100 per segment	**180 appraisals, 60 per segment**	Small effects go unseen

Both designs in Santiago (487 dealers). Realistic: B2B weighted, design effect 1.37; B2C before weighting. Class: per segment, 3 groups is ideal, 2 rigorous, 1 the minimum (Scherman, 2026a).

Every objective has its cell

Who answers each specific objective, where we read it, and the trade-offs behind the numbers.

	Specific objective (SO)	Who answers	Where we read it	Decision
1	SO1 **Physical & aesthetic**	B2B B2C	Severity of each damage, by car value segment	**Damage classes**
2	SO2 **Cost foresight**	B2B	Appraisals blind vs. with cost, by value segment	**Offer rule**
3	SO3 **Adoption barriers**	B2B B2C	Private vs. company; bought vs. about to buy	**Report wording**
4	SO4 **Workshop experience**	B2B	Days and hours lost, by dealer size (SII bracket)	**App flow and timing**
5	SO5 **Appeal and adoption**	B2B B2C	Prices: dealer total (100); each seller type (150)	**B2B and B2C prices**

Budget · time · reach
what we compared

✓ Ideal B2B 100 | ✓ Real B2B 60 | × B2B 150 | ✓ Ideal B2C 300 | ✓ Real B2C 180 | × B2C 400

150 dealers would be 31% of the 487 in Santiago; 400 buyers needs a large paid panel. Ideal: 100 + 300. Realistic, two weeks: 60 + 180 (previous slide).

The macro-environment: a PESTEL radiography

What surrounds Chile's used-car trade, described, not judged: country, industry and global levels, and what is still uncertain.

Political
Government 2026–2030, car theft, bills, trade

Economic
Growth, jobs, volumes, prices

Social
Fraud, who buys, AI use, buying habits

Technological
SMEs and AI, connectivity, data, damage AI

Environmental
Electrification, fleet age, Santiago rules

Legal
Consumer law, registry, data law, recalls

How we built it: five rules from the brief

Described, not judged
No finding is labelled opportunity or threat.

Checked at the source
Each figure was found in the document it cites.

Source beside the idea
Two sources per finding, named on the card itself.

Three levels
Country, industry and, where it applies, global.

Both sides, and doubts
Favourable and unfavourable data, contradictions and open questions.

Political: the State tracks cars more closely

A new government, falling car theft, and bills that change what can be imported.

Country · Government

2026–30

José Antonio Kast's term, from March 2026

The National Public Security Policy 2025–2031 (Decree 96, Jan 2026) lists car theft and receiving stolen goods among its target crimes.

→ Car theft is on the State's agenda across governments.

Minsegpres (2026); Decreto N.° 96 (2026)

Industry · Car theft

−22%

violent car theft, 2025 vs 2024

2,293 fewer cases, and −18.3% in Q1 2026. All car thefts: 39,166 → 36,868.

→ Fewer thefts, but still about 37,000 cases a year.

SPD (2026a, 2026b); UNAB (2026)

Industry · Used imports

New only

cars Chile may import today (Law 18.483, art. 21)

Bill 18.607-15 (Aug 2026) would allow some used EVs and hybrids. It is in its first reading.

→ If passed, a new source of used cars, with batteries to check.

Ley N.° 18.483 (1985); Senado (2026b)

Global · Trade

100%

US tariff on Chinese EVs (2024)

EU duties of 17.0–35.3% (2024). Chile: FTA with China since 2006; 0.49% average effective tariff on all Chinese imports (2023).

→ Chile stays open while large markets close.

USTR (2024); European Commission (2024); SUBREI (2025)

Car theft falls and traceability rules tighten, while Chile stays open to Chinese imports that the US and EU restrict; the used-import bill is undecided.

Economic: slower economy, growing market

Growth under 1% and higher unemployment, while transfers and asking prices rise.

Country · Growth

0.25–0.75%

GDP forecast for 2026 (Central Bank, Sep)

Cut from 1.0–1.75% in June; 2–3% expected for 2027. Unemployment reached 9.6% (Jun–Aug).

→ Frames household income and the cost of car loans.

Banco Central de Chile (2026a); Vargas (2026); INE (2026)

Industry · Volume

908,310

used cars transferred, Jan–Oct 2026 (+3.0%)

1,060,919 in 2025 (+5.8%); 3.4 used cars change hands per new car. October fell 7.0%.

→ The size of the market dealers buy and sell in.

CAVEM (2026a); The Clinic (2026b)

Industry · Prices

+5%

average asking price in 2025: CLP 18.4M

Chileautos listings: CLP 17.5M (2024) → 18.4M. A Ford F-150 was listed from CLP 2.0M to 68.9M. Asking prices, not sale prices.

→ Wide price spread for the same car.

Guzmán (2026), Emol; Reyes (2026), BioBioChile

Global · US prices

205.9

Manheim used-car value index, Sep 2026 (−0.6%)

Used EV prices rose 4.3% in a year while non-EVs fell 1.6%; EVs reached a record 4.9% of Manheim sales in Q3.

→ Segments of the used market can move in opposite directions.

Cox Automotive (2026b, 2026c)

The economy slows (GDP 0.25–0.75%, unemployment 9.6%), yet used-car transfers and asking prices rise; October transfers fell 7%.

Social: people compare online, then see the car

Most used cars are bought by people, amid a 12-year high in fraud and growing use of AI.

Country · Fraud

41,700

fraud cases filed in court, Jan–Sep 2025 (+64%)

A 12-year high across all fraud types, not only cars; 69% are scams. The Fiscalía reports 68% of all 2025 cases with an unknown suspect.

→ Court data do not separate car fraud from other fraud.

Melelli Viveros (2026), Pauta; Ministerio Público (2026)

Industry · Who buys

84.7%

of used cars bought by people, Sep 2026

85.7% in Oct. In Santiago, car trips rose from 27.6% (2012) to 31.7% (2024) of all trips.

→ Buyers are mostly people; the data do not show who sold.

CAVEM (2026c); The Clinic (2026b); Cedeus (2024)

Country · AI use

78%

of Chileans have used generative AI

43% use it to compare prices, but only 26% use it before buying (56% read reviews). 59% say they cannot spot AI errors.

→ High use of AI, low confidence in judging its answers.

The Clinic (2026a); Diario USACH (2026)

Global · In person

86%

of US consumers need to see and test-drive the car

53% of US buyers did every step at the dealer; only 7% bought fully online.

→ Physical inspection stays part of the purchase.

Deloitte (2025); Cox Automotive (2026a)

People buy most used cars and compare prices with AI, yet 59% can't spot AI errors, most US buyers want to see the car, and fraud is at a 12-year high.

Technological: connected, but AI is still early

Phones and data are everywhere; turning them into daily tools is slower.

Country · SMEs and AI

70%

of SMEs use AI (large firms: over 80%)

Yet 70% of 40,000+ self-assessed small firms sit at an initial digital level; lack of staff training is a main barrier (40%).

→ Using AI is not the same as building it into daily work.

Entel Digital (2025); Min. de Economía (2026)

Country · Connectivity

10.8M

5G connections, Jun 2026 (+31.8%)

30.8 GB a month per mobile line; 5G used by 51.9% of households (37.9% rural). 96.5% of homes have internet.

→ Photos and records can be checked from the dealer's lot.

Subtel (2026a, 2026b)

Industry · Car data

CLP 8,990

a full vehicle history report

Owners, mileage, liens and fines in one report. The official transfer is still in person at the Civil Registry.

→ Data on a car comes from several sources, public and paid.

Autofact (n.d.-a); ChileAtiende (2026)

Global · Damage AI

55

studies on AI damage detection reviewed

Results vary by task and data; minor damage and uncontrolled photos remain hard. 74% of US dealers cite accuracy as their top AI barrier.

→ Photo AI reads visible damage, within known limits.

Hasan et al. (2025); Cox Automotive (2025)

Connectivity is wide and SME use of AI is broad but shallow; damage-reading AI works, within known limits.

Environmental: new cars electrify, used stay old

Targets apply to new cars; the used market changes with a lag of years.

Country · Targets

2035

100% zero-emission new light vehicles (20% by 2030)

Plug-ins were 6.3% of new sales in Jan–Sep 2026, but EVs and hybrids are 0.5% of the fleet (2024).

→ The fleet changes slowly; used stock stays mostly combustion.

Min. de Energía (2026); ANAC (2026); INE (2025)

Industry · Fleet age

23.8%

of 2025 transfers were cars 16+ years old (sum of CAVEM data)

CAVEM counts 6.74M vehicles, renewing 4.9% a year; INE counts 6.59M with a circulation permit (2024).

→ Many cars sold predate today's emission standards.

CAVEM (2026b); INE (2025)

Country · Santiago

≤ 2011

green-sticker cars restricted in winter 2026

Cars without a green sticker may not enter the Américo Vespucio ring. In 2018 such cars lost 10% of value in five months.

→ Model year decides where a car may drive.

MMA (2026); CAVEM (2018)

Global · Used EVs

35%

value kept by used EVs in Europe, 2025 (market: ~50%)

Batteries lose 2.3% a year on average (22,700 EVs). The EU requires a battery passport from Feb 2027.

→ Battery health becomes part of an EV's price.

IEA (2026); Geotab (2026); European Parliament & Council (2023)

New sales electrify while the used fleet stays old and combustion; abroad, battery health enters EV prices.

Legal: disclosure, registry and data rules

What a dealer must tell, what the registry checks, and a data law whose start date is in play.

Country · Consumer law

Art. 14

Law 19.496 on consumer protection

If a dealer states before the sale that a car is used, the legal warranty (repair, replace, refund) does not apply; any warranty it offers does.

→ SERNAC covers sales by firms only: 10.9% of car complaints (2020–23) were used-car sales.

Ley N.° 19.496 (1997), arts. 1, 14, 20; SERNAC (2019); Reyes (2023)

Country · Registry

2023

Law 21.601 against the sale of stolen cars

Plates etched on windows and mirrors; first-sale invoices only from issuers on a Civil Registry list (art. 39 bis).

→ Auto Seguro, a State portal, shows if a car is reported stolen.

Ley N.° 21.601 (2023); SPD (2026c)

Country · Data

1 Dec 2026

Law 21.719 on personal data takes effect, by law

The Senate voted on 28 Oct to move it to 15 Oct 2027; the Chamber has not voted yet. Fines up to 5,000, 10,000 or 20,000 UTM by severity.

→ Apps that process photos and buyer data fall under it.

Ley N.° 21.719 (2024); Contreras Espinoza (2026)

Industry · Recalls

126

JAC X200 cars under a SERNAC safety alert (Feb 2026)

Warranties differ on resale: MG's battery cover passes to new owners; GWM's 10-year engine cover is for the first owner only.

→ A used car's remaining cover depends on brand and owner.

SERNAC (2026); MG Motor Chile (n.d.); GWM Chile (n.d.)

Disclosure, registry checks and data rules set what a dealer must tell and verify; the data law's start date is still in play.

Across PESTEL: Chinese brands reach used cars

One factor seen from several dimensions: economic, social, political and technological.

Economic · Share

34.2%

of new cars, Jan–Sep 2026, were Chinese brands

In used cars: 12.95% of transfers (95,353); Chery and MG lead. The used share trails the new one because these cohorts are recent.

→ Their used stock grows as recent cohorts reach resale.

CAVEM (2026c); The Clinic (2026b)

Economic · Depreciation

35–45%

value lost in 3 years, Chinese brands (traditional: 25–35%), an expert's estimate

Chileautos puts the gap at 5–10 points. CAVEM: brands with 10+ years in Chile keep competitive resale values.

→ Depreciation varies by brand, not just by origin.

Gutiérrez (2025), Emol; CAVEM (2026d)

Social · Perception

48%

would never buy a car made in China

Yet 49% link Chinese brands with value for money, 43% with technology. In China, Chinese brands log 201 problems per 100 cars vs 191 for international ones.

→ Origin and attributes pull in opposite directions.

Ortega (2025), La Tercera; J.D. Power (2026)

Political · Subsidies

Dec 2022

China ended its national EV purchase subsidy

After 12 years. A purchase-tax exemption and a trade-in subsidy (2024) remained; spending per car fell 25% (2022–24). In Jan 2026 regulators told EV makers to resist price wars.

→ State support in China shifted, it did not vanish.

IEA (2025); MIIT (2026)

Chinese brands are a third of new sales and 13% of used transfers; perception, reliability and depreciation differ by brand.

What is still uncertain

Rules and forecasts that shape the used-car market and are still moving, November 2026.

Legal · Data law

2026 or 2027?

when Law 21.719 takes effect

By law, 1 Dec 2026. The Senate voted 33–6 on 28 Oct to move it to 15 Oct 2027; the Chamber has not voted yet.

→ Firms do not yet know which date applies.

Ley N.° 21.719 (2024); Contreras Espinoza (2026)

Economic · Outlook

143.4

Central Bank economic uncertainty index, Sep 2026

Up from 103.6 in Feb (148.5 in May). The 2026 GDP forecast was cut from 1.0–1.75% to 0.25–0.75%.

→ Demand and credit forecasts are less stable.

Banco Central de Chile (2026a, 2026b)

Political · Bills

2 bills

in the Senate that touch this market

Bill 18.607-15 would allow some used EV and hybrid imports (first reading); the Executive proposed a redesigned AI framework law (May 2026).

→ Used-import supply and AI rules are not settled.

Senado (2026a, 2026b)

Global · Trade

100%

US tariff on Chinese EVs; EU duties 17.0–35.3%

Cox Automotive lists the timing of Chinese EV imports among the key variables for the US used market in 2027.

→ Where Chinese cars go next is decided abroad.

USTR (2024); European Commission (2024); Cox Automotive (2026c)

The data-law date, the economic outlook, two bills and trade rules on Chinese EVs are all moving at once.

What the radiography shows

One line per dimension, plus what is still uncertain. Selecting what matters most comes next, with Porter and SWOT.

	Dimension	What it shows
P	**Political**	Car theft falls and traceability rules tighten, while Chile stays open to Chinese imports that the US and EU restrict; the used-import bill is undecided.
E	**Economic**	The economy slows (GDP 0.25–0.75%, unemployment 9.6%), yet used-car transfers and asking prices rise; October transfers fell 7%.
S	**Social**	People buy most used cars and compare prices with AI, yet 59% can't spot AI errors, most US buyers want to see the car, and fraud is at a 12-year high.
T	**Technological**	Connectivity is wide and SME use of AI is broad but shallow; damage-reading AI works, within known limits.
A	**Environmental**	New sales electrify while the used fleet stays old and combustion; abroad, battery health enters EV prices.
L	**Legal**	Disclosure, registry checks and data rules set what a dealer must tell and verify; the data law's start date is still in play.
X	**Across**	Chinese brands are a third of new sales and 13% of used transfers; perception, reliability and depreciation differ by brand.
U	**Uncertainty**	The data-law date, the economic outlook, two bills and trade rules on Chinese EVs are all moving at once.

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Thank you

1 Diagnosis
Information asymmetry between buyers and sellers.

2 Objective
Understand what certainty is worth.

3 Method
Listen first, then measure.

4 Sample & PESTEL
100 + 300 surveys; a growing market, moving rules.

Questions?



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